

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Do We Adapt to the Cold?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 25

No.	Sentence
1	Listeners come from various locations worldwide, including extremely cold nations such as _____, where temperatures in winter can fall to -20°C
2	The coldest temperature documented on the planet was _____
3	This extreme cold was recorded in _____
4	People's response to cold is influenced by multiple elements, including genetic makeup, cultural background, _____, and clothing choices
5	Professor Gunhild Sætren resides on an icy island situated _____ inside the Arctic Circle
6	Gender differences: males tend to be _____ than females
7	Experience: whether someone is accustomed to _____
8	Herders experience _____ daily and have been doing so for hundreds of years
9	Their response is measured and contrasted with typical Finns from _____ of the nation
10	Subjectively speaking, the herders cope with cold conditions _____
11	Physically, they are _____ to shiver
12	Cold adaptation may involve _____ inherited from parents to offspring
13	The record-breaking temperature was measured at a research facility in _____
14	in _____
15	A shiver is a trembling motion produced by _____ when experiencing cold or fear

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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What is Becca's attitude towards cold weather compared to heat?

- A She prefers the cold and finds it refreshing
- B She prefers being too hot rather than too cold
- C She is indifferent to temperature extremes
- D She dislikes both heat and cold equally

What is the main purpose of Phil mentioning people in the UK wearing T-shirts while others wear warm clothes?

- A To explain how clothes protect us differently
- B To introduce the topic of varying cold tolerance
- C To highlight British fashion trends in winter
- D To criticize those who dress inappropriately for cold

What does Gunhild Sætren mean by 'first and foremost' when talking about gender differences in cold tolerance?

- A It is the most important factor to consider
- B It is one of the many minor factors
- C It is the least relevant consideration
- D It is an outdated idea no longer true

Which factor besides gender does Gunhild mention affects how people feel the cold?

- A The clothes they wear daily
- B Whether they are used to cold environments
- C Their diet and nutrition
- D Their level of physical fitness

Why does Phil say 'there is some debate about whether men or women are more tolerant of the cold'?

- A To show there is scientific consensus on gender differences
- B To provide proof men are definitely tougher
- C To introduce a disputed topic without firm conclusions
- D To emphasize that gender is irrelevant

What does Becca imply about people born in Arctic Svalbard compared with those from Brazil?

- A People from cold places feel less cold due to environmental and physical factors
- B People from Brazil are better at coping with the cold
- C Place of birth has no impact on cold tolerance
- D People from Svalbard dress poorly for the cold

What is the implied meaning of 'subjectively' in the context of reindeer herders handling cold?

- A Their tolerance is based on measured, objective facts
- B Their feelings are irrelevant to scientific study
- C Their experience of cold is based on personal perception rather than hard data
- D Their shivering indicates high tolerance objectively

What does Dr Cara Ocobock mean when she says 'the more data we collect... the more confusing the picture gets'?

- A The effects of cold tolerance are very simple to understand
- B Their study has clear and predictable results
- C The findings about cold adaptation are complicated and not clear-cut
- D They have not yet started collecting any data

What can be inferred about reindeer herders' physical adaptation to extreme cold?

- A They have identical physical responses to ordinary Finns
- B They shiver more frequently than people from warmer regions
- C They are less likely to shiver, suggesting some physical adaptation
- D They do not need any protective clothing in Arctic conditions

According to the programme, what causes shivering in cold environments?

- A Shivering is an involuntary muscle movement to generate heat
- B Shivering is a voluntary exercise to warm up
- C Shivering is a sign of enjoying cold weather
- D Shivering only happens when a person is afraid